as a guide will help to get the right balance of nutritious foods within the calorie range.

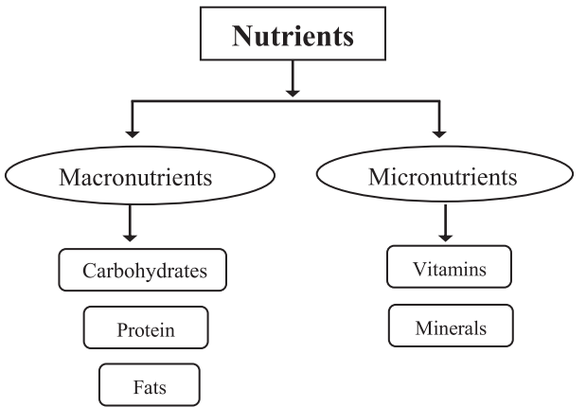


A food pyramid or diet pyramid is a triangular diagram representing the optimal number of servings to be eaten each day from each of the basic food groups.

The first pyramid was published in Sweden in 1974.

4.6 NUTRIENTS

The substances which are present in the food and consumed in our body for its vital functions are called nutrients. According to the World Health Organization (WHO), these nutrients must come from food, and they are vital for disease prevention, growth, and good health. There are several constituents such as:



Classification of nutrients

I. Carbohydrates

Carbohydrates are the chief sources of energy (Providing 4 Kcals/gm). Carbohydrates are cheap and readily available from food. There are three different kinds of carbohydrates. They include starch, sugar, and fibre. We do not get calories from fibre because our bodies do not break down fibre during digestion.



The chemical composition of carbohydrates includes carbon, hydrogen and oxygen (CH_2O).

Classification of Carbohydrates

1. Monosaccharides: These are the simplest form of carbohydrates containing simple sugar molecule. **Example:** Glucose, Fructose and Galactose.
2. Disaccharides: These carbohydrates composed of two units of Monosaccharides. **Example:** Sucrose, Lactose and Maltose.
3. Polysaccharides: These are the complex sugars containing numerous units of monosaccharide molecules. **Example:** Glycogen, Cellulose and Pectins.

Daily requirements

Carbohydrate intake should be in the range of 300-500gm (50%- 70%) out of the total energy intake for adults and 40-60% for children.

Sources: All sugars, jaggery, honey, pulses, whole grains, cereals, grains, rice, fruits, milk, yogurt, beans, roots and tubers such as potatoes, beet root etc.

Functions of Carbohydrates

1. Supplies energy
2. Protein sparing function
3. Oxidation of fats
4. Regulating blood glucose
5. Facilitates bowel movements

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